

1 GAME OVERVIEW

Objective: Keep every colored sand timer running while the team plays every Kite card.

- * Win: Play every card from the draw piles and all players hands before any timer empties.
- * Core tension: Every turn is live. Communicate, watch the shortest timers, and never pause.

2 SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- A

B

C

D

E

F

G

H
- Pool the sand in each timer on one side, then lay all 6 timers flat in the center.

Set aside all 12 Challenge cards for the standard game.

Shuffle the 53 Kite cards.

Deal face-down hands: 2 players = 5 each; 3-4 players = 4 each; 5-6 players = 3 each.

Place the remaining cards in reachable draw piles.

Choose the start player. Nobody looks at cards yet.

Confirm everyone is ready. Play cannot pause after White starts.

Stand the White timer upright. Players immediately look at their hands and play begins.

3 STRUCTURE OF A TURN

1. PLAY ONE CARD

Place 1 card face-up in your personal play pile.

2. FLIP TIMERS

Single symbol: flip that color OR White.
Double symbol: flip both shown colors; never White.

3. RETURN TIMERS

Place all flipped timers back on the table. You must perform your own flips unless another player was designated before play.

4. DRAW

After all required flips, draw 1 replacement card if a draw pile remains.

5. NEXT PLAYER

Clockwise play continues immediately. The next player may begin after timers are back down, even before the prior player draws.

4 TABLE SETUP



- A

B

C

D
- 6 timers on sides

Face-down hands

Reachable draw pile

Personal play piles

START SIGNAL: Stand up the White 60-second timer only after all players understand the rules and are ready.

1 KEY MECHANICS

Single-symbol card

Flip the matching colored timer OR the White timer.

Double-symbol card

Flip both matching colored timers. White is not an option.

Physical flipping

The active player flips the timers. Both hands may be used.

Timing

You may wait before playing, but every timer keeps running.

Draw timing

Draw only after all required timers are flipped and returned.

Communication

Call out urgent timers and intended flips. Cooperation is expected.

Knocked timer

Set it upright again immediately and continue.

Grand Finale

When draw piles empty, finish all hands. White can no longer be flipped.

2 SCORING SUMMARY

Score = total cards left in draw piles, player hands, and played challenge effects when a timer runs out.

0	You blew everyone away!
1-6	Flying high
7-15	Lifting spirits
16-20	Lofty plans taking shape
21-39	A slight breeze
40-60	No wind in sight

3 STRATEGIC TIPS

GOOD HABITS

- * Call out timers that are almost empty.
- * Protect Red and Orange first; their windows are shortest.
- * Use single cards on White before the draw piles empty.

COMMON MISTAKES

- * Do not use a double-symbol card on White.
- * Do not draw before finishing every required flip.
- * Do not wait so long that another timer expires.

ADVANCED

- * Delay briefly only when a controlled wait improves several timers.
- * Plan the final hand before White becomes unavailable.

4 CHALLENGE CARDS

After learning the base game, add any number of Challenge cards. Deal player hands first, then shuffle selected challenges into the remaining deck.

STORM

When drawn, announce it. Play it as the only card on your next turn.

CROSSED LINES

Adds a temporary communication restriction. Follow the card until cleared.

AIRPLANE

Adds a temporary physical disruption. Follow the card text exactly.

WARM-UP: Remove Orange and Purple timers plus every Kite card showing either color.

5 END OF GAME

- * TEAM WIN: Every card in all draw piles and hands has been played.
- * CRASH: Any timer completely runs out. Stop and count remaining cards for the score band.
- * No tie-breaker: Kites is fully cooperative. Improve the team score on the next flight.